

Alana Edwards

Full Stack Software Engineer | UX/Product & Interaction Design | Chicago, IL, 60605,
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SUMMARY

Product-driven Full Stack Software Engineer with hands-on experience designing and building user-centered web and mobile applications. Strong background translating user needs and product requirements into intuitive interfaces using Figma, SwiftUI, React, and Rails. Experienced in agile methodologies, cross-functional environments, combining UX thinking, frontend development, backend APIs, and systems design to deliver scalable, accessible, and impactful products. Currently enhancing product design and AI-driven UX skills through a selective UX apprenticeship.

SKILLS

Languages: Ruby, JavaScript/TypeScript, Python, Swift, C++, Bash

Frontend: React, HTML, CSS, SwiftUI, AJAX/jQuery, Fetch API

Backend: Ruby on Rails, Sinatra, Flask, FastAPI

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL

DevOps & Cloud: Docker, Nginx, AWS, DigitalOcean, GitHub Actions

Testing & Monitoring: RSpec, Minitest, Cucumber, unitest, Prometheus, Grafana

UX / Product: UX Design Principles, Wireframing & Prototyping (Figma), User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, MVP Development, Design-to-Engineering Collaboration

APIs & Auth: REST APIs, OAuth (GitHub, Google, Mapbox)

Version Control: Git, GitHub

WORK EXPERIENCE

UX Woman

UX Apprentice, Remote

February 2026 - Present

- Selected as 1 of 2 participants for the highly competitive UX Woman Spring 2026 UX Apprenticeship
- Leading an end-to-end UX project for a startup concept, from discovery research through wireframing, prototyping, and iteration
- Conducting user discovery research and synthesizing insights to inform product and design decisions
- Creating core UX deliverables including personas, journey maps, UX flows, wireframes, and prototypes
- Developing business and product context through market analysis, positioning, and UX-driven product pitches

Meta x MLH Fellowship

Production Engineer (Site Reliability Engineer) Fellow, Remote

June 2025 - September 2025

- Selected for the highly competitive Meta x MLH Fellowship, with an acceptance rate of just 2.5%, to contribute to impactful real-world infrastructure projects
- Engineered and deployed a scalable, containerized application using Docker and Nginx on DigitalOcean
- Automated CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions to improve deployment speed and reliability
- Administered Linux servers, writing Bash scripts, and monitoring system performance to ensure uptime
- Implemented unit tests to validate key application functionality
- Partnered with Meta engineers to implement production-grade infrastructure and best practices

Everyone Can Code Chicago

iOS App Developer Intern, Chicago, IL

June 2024 - August 2024

- Collaborated with a team of developers to design and implement iOS app features
- Created wireframes and storyboards in Figma to explore early product concepts
- Built interactive user interfaces using SwiftUI and MapKit
- Delivered a Minimum Viable Product (MVP) pitch to Apple executives
- Used Git for version control in a team-based development environment

Discovery Partners Institute

Software Developer Apprentice, Chicago, IL

February 2024 - May 2024

- Conducted user research, gathered feedback, and created user stories to define requirements before coding
- Designed wireframes and UX flows to guide development of responsive, user-friendly interfaces
- Developed scalable full-stack applications using Ruby on Rails and PostgreSQL, applying object-oriented programming principles and a problem-first approach
- Implemented front-end features with HTML, CSS, and jQuery, ensuring responsive and user-friendly interfaces
- Utilized AWS for image storage, enhancing application functionality and performance

PROJECTS

Build Carolina Academy

Remote

SecureAKey

July 2025 - Present

- Developed an API key scanning tool that identifies exposed API keys in GitHub repositories
- Enabled users to log in via GitHub OAuth, input a repository name, and receive a detailed report showing the exact key, file name, and line number of exposed secrets
- Tech stack: FastAPI (backend, GitHub API integration), React (frontend), PostgreSQL/Supabase (database), GitHub OAuth + JWT (auth), deployed via Render

Discovery Partners Institute

Chicago, IL

Muse

March 2024 - Present

- Pioneered an innovative customer-driven web app with Ruby on Rails and PostgreSQL; employing a unique sales approach to differentiate itself from competitors
- Implemented user authentication, product listings, and dynamic filtering and designed relational database models to support users, products, and transactional data
- Designed a curated social media-inspired UI for improved listing discoverability
- Translated user feedback into iterative UI and backend feature improvements

Discovery Partners Institute

Chicago, IL

Homeless Resource Index

January 2024 - January 2024

- Developed a lightweight resource-indexing application using Ruby and Sinatra
- Implemented Google Places API to locate resources in real time; improving search results' speed and accuracy
- Designed an accessible, intuitive UI with semantic HTML and mobile-friendly search flows
- Provided a directory of resources for people experiencing homelessness and housing insecurity based on geographic location

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Creating Coding Careers

Instructor – Student Support (Contract, Part Time), Remote

February 2026 - Present

- Teach full-stack web development concepts including HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and React to adult students of varying technical backgrounds
- Mentor students through debugging, project architecture decisions, and implementation of industry best practices
- Assess student projects and provide structured, actionable technical feedback to improve code quality and problem-solving skills
- Collaborate with instructors and leadership to refine curriculum materials and enhance student learning outcomes

Build Carolina Academy

Teaching Assistant, Remote

April 2025 - August 2025

- Assisted 7 students in a 20-week part-time coding bootcamp with assignments and technical challenges, providing one-on-one and small group support
- Addressed student questions, escalating unresolved issues to the instructor or relevant staff
- Fostered collaboration by connecting students with similar challenges and guiding peer-to-peer problem solving
- Collaborated with the instructor to develop and review content, ensuring all materials are approved prior to distribution
- Gained hands-on experience with foundational Python, React, FastAPI, and Supabase/PostgreSQL

EDUCATION

Illinois Institute of Technology Stuart School of Business, Chicago, IL

- Graduate level coursework

University of Illinois - Discovery Partners Institute Tech Apprenticeship, Chicago, IL

Certificate of Completion Software Development

- Relevant coursework: Software Engineering

LANGUAGE

Korean: (Limited working proficiency), **Swedish** (Elementary proficiency)

INTERESTS

Crochet, Reading, Video Gaming, Yoga, Tennis, Photography, Music, Soccer, Dance, Traveling